

by tech entrepreneur Luke Metcalfe that generates suburb reports based on liveability and desirability, crunching algorithms across demographics, political voting preferences, infrastructure and geography. In Brisbane, Microburbs research found that Fortitude Valley, Petrie Terrace, West End, New Farm and Milton all scored 9.5 out of 10 on their custom hip-o-meter. A greater number of trendy suburbs exist in Brisbane near the city nerve centre compared to other capital cities.

Microburbs has Australia-wide heat maps that drill into regions by profession, income, religion, age, education, long-term residents and dwelling type, and suburb reports that include highly detailed breakdowns of scores for schooling, convenience, tranquillity, safety and 'hipness' (diversity of residents, tattoo parlours, pubs, galleries and restaurants). I highly recommend making Microburbs a resource in your home search.

Plenty of first home buyers – myself included – dream of getting into a lively suburb on our debut attempt. But we need to check our expectations at the door. OpenAgent chief executive Zoe Pointon says research from her comparison site shows first home buyers are making trade-offs to get into the market:

That actually hasn't changed between generations. I'm not saying it hasn't gotten harder; it has. But if [millennials] asked their parents, they would say, 'When I bought property I made sacrifices.'

Source: domain.com.au/advice/the-best-suburbs-for-millennials-to-buy-property-according-to-new-report-20160822-ggxy6u/

Will Unkles agrees that the property market has always been a ladder climb and it is a myth that most baby boomers, in the flush of young love and settling down in a first property, made their entry into what are now hot neighbourhoods. 'Talk to any of your parents and they will all tell you their first place was a dump, and we have to do the same,' he says. At the same time, years of unbridled house price growth have outpaced income growth and savings, nudging the suburbs where we rent and socialise out of reach, even for those diligently squirrelling away great wads of their salary. 'It is